

AISHA SALIH

(She/Her)

Aix-Marseille School of Economics ◊ aisha.salih@univ-amu.fr

EDUCATION

Aix-Marseille School of Economics (AMSE)

Sept. 2021 - Present

PhD Economics

Advisors: Habiba Djebbari, Timothée Demont

Primary Fields: Development Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Secondary Fields: Climate Change, Networks, Migration

Toulouse School of Economics (TSE)

Sept. 2020 - Oct. 2021

MSc Economics - Public Policy & Development (*cum laude*)

Paris Institute of Political Studies (Sciences Po)

Sept. 2017 - June. 2019

Master of Public Policy - Economics & Public Policy

University of Khartoum

Sept. 2010 - Dec. 2014

BA(Honours) - Linguistics & Comparative Literature

WORK IN PROGRESS

Neighborhood Business: Exchange Networks and Wage Markets in Rural Thailand *Job Market Paper*

This paper studies how informal labor relationships shape the allocation of wage work as rural labor markets develop. In many village economies, reciprocal labor exchange and hired labor coexist, raising a central question: when agricultural labor demand rises, do households substitute away from informal obligations toward anonymous spot-market hiring, or do existing relationships mediate the transition to wage contracts? We answer this question using the Townsend Thai monthly panel, which links household labor outcomes to dyadic transaction records that identify whether hired workers were prior exchange partners. A monthly Bartik shifter, constructed from predetermined village crop specialization and national producer-price growth, provides short-run variation in local farm-labor demand. Average labor quantities respond weakly, consistent with common village-level shocks in relatively closed labor markets. The main response is instead compositional: hired-labor transactions are more likely to occur within sampled pre-existing labor relationships, especially baseline dual ties, than with sampled new partners. The evidence suggests that declining reciprocal exchange need not imply the disappearance of village labor networks; rather, persistent ties can serve as relational infrastructure for wage transactions.

Harvesting Hope: Climate Shocks and Religion in Sub-Saharan Africa

With Eva Raiber (Aix-Marseille University, CNRS)

We examine how climate shocks affect religious contributions in Nigeria using household panel data from the Nigeria General Household Survey (2010–2019) combined with the Standardised Precipitation–Evapotranspiration Index (SPEI). Severe drought and pluvial shocks have opposite effects on religious giving. Two severe drought months increase religious expenditure and raise the probability of any contribution by 9 to 10 percentage points. Merging LSMS consumption aggregates, we show that this increase occurs even as total household consumption falls by 16 percent, constituting direct evidence of deliberate reallocation toward religion rather than a mechanical income effect. Severe pluvial shocks reduce religious giving and lower the giving probability by 5 to 7 percentage points. The drought effect is concentrated among Christian households, in urban areas, and among higher-consumption households, and is not confined to crop-holding households, pointing toward a community engagement channel in which religious organisations mobilise giving in response to a salient and widespread shock. Afrobarometer evidence corroborates this interpretation: perceived drought severity is associated with

greater reliance on religious coping networks and higher trust in religious leaders, while objective pluvial exposure reduces that trust. The pluvial effect is negative and uniform across sectors and religious groups, consistent with a resource constraint channel.

Measuring Temporary Migration in Agrarian Economies: Concepts, Survey Methods, Biases, and Future Directions

With Timothée Demont (Aix-Marseille University, CNRS)

Temporary and seasonal migration is an important adjustment margin for rural households in developing economies, especially where agricultural income is seasonal and formal insurance is limited. Yet empirical estimates of temporary migration vary widely across surveys. This paper treats survey design as a primary source of this variation and develops a framework for interpreting what different instruments measure. We distinguish three population estimands: point prevalence, person-time prevalence, and annual incidence, and map common household-survey designs to the quantities they identify. Using the Tanzania National Panel Survey, we show that a snapshot roster indicator misses 46–63 percent of the absence recorded by a twelve-month recall indicator on the same individuals. Cross-country LSMS-ISA comparisons show that the same nested logic holds where roster items are comparable, although levels depend on item wording. Because recall is incomplete and roster dropouts remain unobserved, these estimates are lower bounds on snapshot undercount among listed members rather than estimates of true prevalence. The paper then shows how the framework organizes existing evidence and motivates a low-cost elicitation module that records spell timing, purpose, return expectations, and destination outcomes.

Prevention of Violence Against Women and Girls Through A School-Based Curriculum: Evidence from Kenya

With Mushfiq Mobarak, Sreyashi Sharmin, and Junxing Gu (Yale University)

In Kenya, one-third of girls aged 13-17 experience sexual violence. This human rights violation creates substantial barriers to educational attainment and economic mobility. We evaluate the Empowerment Transformation Training (ETT) program, a school-based intervention implemented by Ujamaa Africa, using a large-scale randomized controlled trial. The program delivers gender-specific curricula to Grade 4-12 students to prevent VAWG and promote gender equity. We estimate causal effects on five primary outcomes: sexual assault incidence, school attendance, academic performance, teen pregnancy/marriage, and personal initiative. Our analysis examines economic mechanisms including human capital formation, social norms, and community externalities. The findings aim to provide evidence for cost-effective Violence Against Women and Girls prevention strategies and to inform policy decisions on national program scale-up.

RESEARCH ACTIVITIES

RESEARCH VISITS

University of Fribourg (<i>scholarship</i>)	Feb. 2026 - Jul. 2026
Advisor: Christelle Dumas	
Yale University & The Yale Research Initiative on Innovation & Scale	Sept. 2024 - Dec. 2024
Advisor: Ahmed Mushfiq Mobarak	

TEACHING & RESEARCH ASSISTANCE

Aix-Marseille University (ATER)	Sept. 2025 - Aug. 2026
Courses: Econometrics (Masters); Introduction to Economics; Data Analysis Using R	
Aix-Marseille University (ATER)	Jan. - Dec. 2025
Courses: Macroeconomics; Industrial Organization	

Centrale Méditerranée (TA) Courses: Introduction to Economics; Game Theory; Finance: Introduction to Economic and Mathematical Modeling	Oct. 2022 - June 2024
Aix-Marseille University (TA) Courses: Microeconomics; Industrial Organization	Oct. 2021 - Dec. 2021
Fondation Jean-Jacques Laffont - Toulouse School of Economics (RA) Research Assistant for Prof. Stéphane Straub Topics: Microeconomics; Infrastructure and Development	Dec. 2020 - June 2021
Sciences Po Paris (TA) Course: Macroeconomics; Debt Restructuring	June 2019 - Sept. 2019

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

Climate Change: Lessons From The Past & Contemporary Challenges, Marseille Co-organizer	May. 2026
Association for the Study of Religion, Economics & Culture (ASREC), Copenhagen Development and cultural economics conference	Sept. 2025
International Conference on Development Economics (ICDE), Aix-En-Provence Development economics conference Best poster award by the French Association for Development Economics (AFEDEV)	July 2024
Les journées Louis-André Gérard-Varet (LAGV), Marseille	June 2024
Les journées doctorales du développement, Orléans Development economics conference	January 2023
Barcelona School of Economics 2022 Summer School Complex Networks Analysis	June - July 2022
The European Investment Bank 2019 Summer School Topic: Strategic Investments in Europe	June - July 2019
The Sciences Po UN Sustainable Development Goals Professional Certificate Research project: the social and economic integration of refugees in Paris, policy gaps and way forward Presented at the 2019 Global Public Policy Network (GPPN) Conference	2017-2019

ACADEMIC RESPONSIBILITIES

2022-2024: PhD Office Manager of the AMSE Marseille lab.
2021-2023: PhD Representative at the Commission de la Recherche (research commission) of Aix-Marseille University.
2021-2022: PhD Office Manager of the AMSE Aix-en-Provence lab.

LANGUAGES & SOFTWARE SKILLS

Arabic (native), English (native), French (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), Italian (intermediate).

R, Stata, QGIS, ArcGIS, Python, Latex.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Allianz Research Research Assistant (macroeconomics, country and sector risk)	Sept. 2019 - March 2020 Paris, France
OECD Directorate for Employment, Labour and Social Affairs Research and Policy Advice Intern	Jan. 2019 - June 2019 Paris, France
OECD Development Co-operation Directorate Graduate Intern	Feb. 2018 - April 2018 Paris, France
The World Bank Project Coordination Consultant	Aug. 2015 - July 2017 Primary base: Khartoum, Sudan
• Research Assistance for the The Sudan Interim Poverty Reduction Strategy Paper Status Report. • Coordination and project monitoring and evaluation support for The Sudan Multi-Partner Fund (SMPF).	
The United Nations Resident Coordinator's Office Coordination & Research Assistant	Aug. 2014 - Aug. 2015 Khartoum, Sudan
The United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) Undergraduate Intern	June - Aug. 2014 Khartoum, Sudan

AWARDS

World Bank VPU Team Award (June 2017) for project coordination role in the Sudan Evidence Base Program.

World Bank Spot Award for individual performance (2016/2017).